

ELSMITH cPanel Setup

The repository now contains a mobile-first booking scheduler, a functional Contact form, and server-side PHP endpoints. The frontend never contains SMTP credentials. Before publishing, complete the following server configuration in cPanel.

1. Upload the project

Upload the website files to the cPanel document root, including `api/`, `booking_ui.js`, `booking_ui.css`, `site_responsive.css`, `.htaccess`, and the existing compiled assets. PHP must be enabled for the account.

2. Create the private PHP configuration

Copy `api/config.example.php` to `api/config.php` on the server only. Do not commit `api/config.php` to GitHub. Set the values as follows:

Setting	Production value
<code>smtp_host</code>	<code>mail.elsmithconsulting.com</code>
<code>smtp_port</code>	<code>465</code>
<code>smtp_username</code>	<code>info@elsmithconsulting.com</code>
<code>smtp_password</code>	The private password for the mailbox, entered only in cPanel/server storage
<code>from_email</code>	<code>info@elsmithconsulting.com</code>
<code>from_name</code>	<code>ELSMITH Consulting Website</code>
<code>notification_email</code>	<code>info@elsmithconsulting.com</code>
<code>timezone</code>	<code>Africa/Lagos</code>
<code>app_secret</code>	A long, random, private value generated for this installation

The SMTP connection uses authenticated SSL/TLS on port 465. The notification recipient is the ELSMITH mailbox, and visitor email addresses are used as `Reply-To` values.

3. Prepare private booking storage

Create a `storage` directory in the project root on the server with permissions that allow the PHP process to write to it. The application creates `bookings.json` and rate-limit files there. The root `.htaccess` denies direct web access to `/storage/`; do not remove that rule.

4. Verify the public endpoints

After configuration, confirm that the following endpoints respond over HTTPS:

Endpoint	Purpose
<code>/api/csrf.php</code>	Creates a session-bound CSRF token
<code>/api/availability.php</code>	Returns configurable available dates and times
<code>/api/availability.php?date=YYYY-MM-DD</code>	Returns available slots for one date
<code>/api/contact.php</code>	Receives and emails Contact form enquiries
<code>/api/booking.php</code>	Validates, stores, and emails booking requests

The availability defaults are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM WAT, 60-minute appointments, and a 15-minute buffer. Blocked dates can be added in `config.php` as an optional `blocked_dates` array using `YYYY-MM-DD` values.

5. Security requirements

Use HTTPS for the live site. Keep `api/config.php` outside version control, restrict its permissions, and never paste its contents into frontend files. The endpoints include server-side required-field and email validation, CSRF validation, a honeypot field, basic IP-based rate limiting, server-side availability checks, duplicate-slot protection, sanitized email headers, and generic public error messages.

6. Frontend behavior

The scheduler is full-screen or comfortably scrollable on small screens and becomes a centered dialog on larger screens. It includes date, time, details, review, loading, success, error, Escape-key, focus, and close states. The full website includes a responsive navigation drawer, fluid typography, mobile-first section spacing, single-column mobile grids, responsive forms, accessible focus states, reduced-motion support, and tablet/desktop refinements.